



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Malawi. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing a bit about yourself — that really helps in guiding you better. Since you're 16, fluent in Danish, and just finished primary school in Denmark (which usually means you're finishing **9th or 10th grade**), you're now at a key decision point in the Danish education system.

Your Main Options After Primary School in Denmark

In Denmark, the most common paths after **Folkeskole** (primary and lower secondary school) are:

🎓 1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (Upper Secondary Education - Academic)

These are ideal if you're thinking about going to **university later**.

- **STX (Almen studentereksamen)** – Broad academic education with a focus on humanities, social sciences, and natural sciences.
- **HHX (Højere handelseksamen)** – Focus on business, economics, marketing.
- **HTX (Højere teknisk eksamen)** – Focus on technical and scientific subjects (great if you like technology or engineering).
- **HF (Højere forberedelseseksamen)** – A 2-year program, more practical and flexible, often used if you're unsure or need a shorter route to higher education.

🟢 **Recommended if:** You enjoy studying, want to keep your options open for university, and like academic subjects.

🔧 2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training - VET)

These combine school and practical training in a job (like an apprenticeship). You can become anything from an electrician, carpenter, chef, to healthcare worker.

- Takes about 3–5 years.
- You can also later take “**EUX**” – a combo of vocational training + academic courses, which allows you to enter university as well.

🟢 **Recommended if:** You like hands-on learning, want to start working sooner, and are interested in a specific profession.

👤 3. 10th Grade (10. klasse)

Optional year if you're not 100% sure what you want to do yet.

● **Recommended if:** You want more time to grow, improve your grades, or explore what you really enjoy before committing.

How to Choose?

Ask yourself:

- Do I like academic subjects or prefer practical work?
 - Am I thinking of going to university, or do I want to get a job sooner?
 - Do I want a mix of school and work experience?
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Bonus Tip – Consider Your Strengths and Background

As someone with Danish and Malawian roots, you may have **strong cross-cultural skills** and **language abilities** (maybe you speak Chichewa or another language too?). This can be an asset in areas like:

- **International business (HHX)**
 - **Healthcare (VET – SOSU assistant, nursing)**
 - **Technology (HTX)**
 - **Education or social work (STX or HF + university)**
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Final Thoughts

If you're academically strong and think you might want to go to university later, **STX** or **HTX** are great options. If you prefer working with your hands and want job experience sooner, a **VET program** or **EUX** is a strong choice.

And if you're unsure, a year in **10th grade** can help you decide.

Would you like me to help you find specific schools or programs near where you live in Denmark?